

The Enterprise SAP Transformation Playbook 2026

Executive insights on SAP S/4HANA adoption, AI-driven transformation,
enterprise migration strategies, governance & security modernization, and industry outlook

The Migration Inflection Point

As the 2027 SAP ECC maintenance deadline approaches, organizations face growing pressure to modernize aging ERP environments while preparing for AI-enabled enterprise operations. The window for strategic planning is narrowing — and the gap between leaders and laggards is widening.

32%

Already Migrated

Organizations live on S/4HANA today

41%

Plan by 2027

Targeting migration before deadline

~35K

ECC Customers

Gartner's global estimate

~17K

ECC Holdouts

Still on ECC by 2027 (est.)

SAP Transformation Has Entered a New Era

Organizations are no longer evaluating SAP migration solely as a technology refresh. Modern transformation initiatives are increasingly tied to strategic business outcomes — demanding alignment across IT, finance, operations, and security leadership.



AI Readiness

Enabling next-gen intelligent operations with embedded AI capabilities across enterprise workflows



Operational Agility

Faster, more responsive enterprise processes across business units and geographies



Security Modernization

Reducing exposure and governance risk across SAP landscapes — from ECC to S/4HANA



Cloud Operating Models

Aligning ERP architecture with cloud-first enterprise strategies and RISE with SAP

SAP S/4HANA Market Landscape

Key adoption statistics reveal both the momentum building behind S/4HANA and the significant scale of work remaining before the 2027 deadline.

32%

Already on S/4HANA

26–27%

Active Implementation

21%

Still Evaluating

39%

Migrated by End 2025

Market Insight	Statistics
Organizations planning migration before 2027	41%
ECC customers globally (Gartner estimate)	~35,000
Estimated ECC holdouts by 2027	~17,000

The 2027 Deadline: A Real Business Risk

SAP ECC mainstream maintenance ends in 2027. For enterprises still running legacy ECC environments, the implications extend well beyond IT — touching security posture, regulatory compliance, operational continuity, and total cost of ownership.



Increased Security Exposure

Unpatched vulnerabilities and expanding attack surfaces persist without vendor support, creating material cybersecurity risk.



Higher Operational Risk

System instability and reduced reliability increase as ECC ages without ongoing updates and fixes from SAP.



Governance Complexity

Maintaining compliance on unsupported platforms becomes progressively more difficult and resource-intensive.



Rising Maintenance Costs

Third-party support contracts and custom patching efforts drive total cost of ownership significantly higher.

AI Is Reshaping SAP Transformation

43%

of enterprises now consider AI capabilities
during ERP decision-making

SAPinsider Research

AI is rapidly becoming one of the strongest catalysts behind SAP modernization programs — and a key differentiator in vendor selection.

AI Capabilities Organizations Are Evaluating



SAP Joule

AI copilot for enterprise workflows and decision support



AI-Assisted Approvals

Intelligent, context-aware workflow automation



Predictive Analytics

Forecasting and demand planning at scale



AI-Powered Governance

Real-time risk detection and compliance monitoring



Autonomous Operations

Hyperautomation reducing manual intervention

Cloud ERP Adoption Accelerates

Enterprise ERP strategies are increasingly shifting toward hybrid cloud, RISE with SAP, private cloud, and multi-cloud operating models. SAP's own financial performance reflects this accelerating market transition.



60–70%

Cloud-Native ERP

Share of new ERP deployments expected to be cloud-native by 2026



27%

SAP Cloud Revenue Growth

Year-over-year growth in SAP cloud revenue, FY2026 Q1

SAP's cloud business momentum signals a clear market shift — cloud-first ERP is no longer optional for competitive enterprises.

Industry Adoption Trends



Manufacturing

Supply chain resilience · Real-time plant operations ·
Predictive maintenance



Retail & Consumer

Omnichannel operations · Demand forecasting ·
Customer intelligence



Financial Services

Governance modernization · Real-time finance · AI-
driven compliance



Healthcare & Life Sciences

Compliance modernization · Secure operations ·
Data governance

The Biggest Migration Challenges

Despite strong migration intent, enterprises consistently encounter four categories of obstacles that slow progress, inflate budgets, and increase delivery risk.

01 Custom Code Complexity

Legacy customizations require extensive analysis, remediation, and regression testing before migration can proceed safely. Many organizations underestimate the volume and interdependency of custom objects.

02 Data Quality & Migration Complexity

Inconsistent, duplicate, or incomplete data creates significant risk during system cutover and go-live. Data cleansing and harmonization must begin well before technical migration.

03 Skills & Resource Shortages

Demand for qualified SAP S/4HANA architects, functional consultants, and integration specialists continues to outpace market supply, driving up cost and extending timelines.

04 Project Cost & Timeline Risks

Migrations frequently exceed initial budgets and planned timelines, requiring robust governance frameworks, executive sponsorship, and contingency planning from the outset.

Migration Models Enterprises Are Evaluating

Choosing the right migration approach is one of the most consequential decisions in any SAP transformation program.

Model	Advantages	Challenges	Best Fit
Greenfield	Process redesign opportunity; clean-slate standardization	Higher transformation effort and business disruption	Organizations seeking process standardization & innovation
Brownfield	Faster transition; preserves existing configurations	Retains legacy complexity and technical debt	Stable ECC environments prioritizing speed
Bluefield	Selective modernization; combines best of both approaches	Higher planning complexity and governance overhead	Large enterprises with mixed modernization needs
RISE with SAP	Simplified cloud operations; managed transformation	Governance and compliance alignment required	Cloud-first organizations seeking managed services
Hybrid	Operational flexibility; phased adoption	Integration complexity across landscapes	Global enterprises with diverse deployment needs

Governance & SAP Security Outlook

Enterprise Governance Priorities

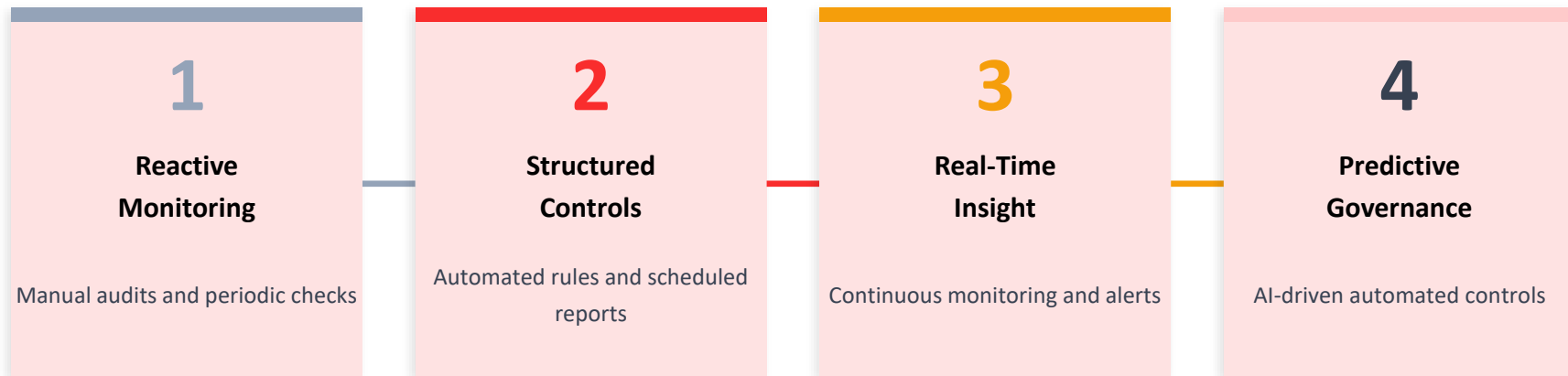
 SoD (Segregation of Duties) management Emergency access governance Identity governance & PAM Audit readiness and compliance reporting Real-time monitoring and alerting

The Rise of AI-Driven Governance

 AI-driven log analysis and anomaly detection Intelligent approvals and workflow automation Automated audit reporting and evidence collection Predictive risk detection before incidents occur Real-time governance monitoring across landscapes

SAP Security: A Board-Level Discussion

As SAP environments expand across ECC, S/4HANA, SAP BTP, and cloud-native platforms, identity complexity, emergency access misuse, and governance fragmentation have elevated SAP security from an IT issue to a board-level priority.



AI-Powered Security Ops

Risk scoring, behavioral log analysis, anomaly detection, and governance automation deliver continuous, intelligent security monitoring across the SAP landscape.



Hybrid SAP Security

Unified governance across ECC, S/4HANA, SAP BTP, and cloud-native environments eliminates fragmented controls and delivers a single, consolidated risk view.

Outlook: 2026–2030



AI-Led Automation

End-to-end AI-driven process automation across finance, procurement, and supply chain



SAP BTP Adoption

Business Technology Platform becomes the integration and extension standard



Autonomous Governance

Self-healing, self-monitoring governance controls operating without manual intervention



Intelligent Finance

AI-driven financial close, forecasting, and real-time management reporting



AI-Enabled Compliance

Continuous, automated compliance monitoring replacing periodic manual audit cycles



Hyperautomation

Orchestrated automation spanning ERP, middleware, and enterprise application layers

Strategic Recommendations for SAP Leaders

1

Focus on Long-Term Operational Agility

Build for flexibility and scalability—not just the migration milestone

2

Build AI Readiness into SAP Roadmaps

Make architecture decisions today that enable AI-driven operations tomorrow.

3

Simplify Before Modernizing

Reduce custom code and process complexity before migration

4

Prioritize Governance Early

Embed security and governance from day one—not as an afterthought.

5

Treat Migration as Business Transformation

Align SAP programs with enterprise strategy—not just IT modernization goals.

SAP Transformation By the Numbers

32–39%

Already Migrated

Organizations currently live on S/4HANA globally

41%

Plan by 2027

Targeting S/4HANA migration before the ECC deadline

43%

AI in ERP Decisions

Enterprises now influenced by AI capabilities in ERP vendor selection

60–70%

Cloud-Native ERP

Expected share of new ERP deployments to be cloud-native by 2026

18–36mo

Migration Timelines

Typical SAP S/4HANA project duration for enterprise-scale programs

70%

Finance Automation

Potential reduction in manual finance work through AI-driven operations

How Maitsys Helps Enterprises Transform

At Maitsys, we believe SAP transformation is no longer simply about ERP modernization — it is about building the foundation for the intelligent enterprise.



SAP S/4HANA Migration

Greenfield, Brownfield, and Hybrid transformation strategies tailored to your environment, timeline, and business objectives.



SAP Security & Governance

SoD modernization, emergency access governance, and AI-driven governance programs that reduce risk and strengthen audit readiness.



SAP AI & Innovation

SAP Joule deployment, AI-assisted operations, and intelligent automation initiatives that accelerate enterprise value realization.



SAP BTP Services

Platform extensions, integration modernization, and workflow automation leveraging SAP Business Technology Platform capabilities.

The Intelligent Enterprise Imperative

Enterprise SAP transformation has entered a critical phase. Organizations are no longer modernizing simply to replace legacy systems — they are modernizing to enable AI, improve governance, accelerate innovation, simplify operations, and reduce enterprise risk at scale.

**SAP S/4HANA migration is no longer simply an ERP project.
It is becoming the foundation for the intelligent enterprise.**

The organizations that modernize strategically today — with clear governance, AI-ready architecture, and strong executive alignment — will be best positioned to lead the next generation of intelligent enterprise operations through 2030 and beyond.

Ready to Assess Your SAP Transformation Strategy?

SAP S/4HANA Readiness Assessment

Schedule a structured assessment to evaluate your current ECC environment, identify migration risks, quantify custom code complexity, and define a clear, actionable path to S/4HANA.

Our assessments deliver executive-ready findings within weeks — giving your leadership team the clarity needed to act with confidence.

Connect With Maitsys

Our SAP transformation experts are ready to help you navigate migration strategy, governance modernization, AI readiness, and SAP BTP enablement — at the pace your business demands.

www.maitsys.com

Schedule your assessment today.

No commitment required.